

Class Notes: Phylum Aschelminthes

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

Body Plan and Digestion

Known as round worms due to circular cross-section body; bilaterally symmetrical, triploblastic, pseudocoelomate, organ system level of organisation. May be free-living (aquatic/terrestrial) or parasitic on plants and animals; alimentary canal is complete with a well-developed muscular pharynx.

Reproduction and Examples

Excretory tube removes waste through the excretory pore. Aschelminthes are dioecious (sexes separate), with females often longer than males; fertilisation is internal, development direct or indirect. Examples: *Ascaris* (round worm, causes Ascariasis), *Wuchereria* (filarial worm, causes Filariasis/Elephantiasis transmitted by mosquitoes — *Anopheles* in Africa, *Culex* in America), *Ancylostoma* (hookworm, infects small intestine of cats and dogs).